

Scholarship Essay

Life is woven through the threads of past, present, and future, each memory becoming a part of our past, every moment shaping our present, and every decision preparing us for the future. It's a fascinating cycle, a beautiful mess where problems and solutions coexist. The closest parallel to this is data and data science. Data, like life, is a vast pool of questions and solutions, where past information informs the present and predicts the future. Through data science, we play with this complexity, extracting insights, identifying patterns, and crafting strategies to create meaningful change. This dynamic interplay mirrors how we use our experiences to navigate challenges, solve problems, and shape a better future, a process that fuels my passion for this transformative field.

I completed my Bachelor of Technology in Information Technology in 2019 from Government Mahila Engineering College, affiliated with Rajasthan Technical University, a prestigious government-funded institution and one of the top state universities in India. During my studies, I built a solid foundation in subjects like Engineering Mathematics, Programming, Data Structures, and Data Mining. For my final project, I developed a classification model to automate email categorization as Spam or Not Spam, demonstrating my ability to apply theoretical knowledge to real-world problems.

In addition to technical skills, I actively participated in extracurricular activities, which helped me develop leadership, organizational, and creative abilities. As Media Committee Secretary, I organized photography and videography events, enhancing my event management skills. I also directed and led a mime act that won first place at the cultural fest "Epistemico." I captained sports teams in Volleyball, Throwball, and Table Tennis during "Taksh," further strengthening my leadership and teamwork skills. These experiences complemented my academic growth and prepared me for future challenges, which led me to start my corporate journey at Cognizant Technology Solutions.

Over my five-year career at Cognizant and Tiger Analytics, I've worked in diverse business domains like RPCG and healthcare, catering to various markets and geographies. My dedication and skills have earned me three promotions, culminating in my current role as a Data Scientist and team lead. I began at Cognizant as a Programmer Analyst Trainee, gaining hands-on experience with tools like Excel, Python, and Pandas to optimize processes such as claim prioritization for an orthopaedic product provider. As a Programmer Analyst, I honed skills in data preparation, visualization, and predictive modeling, delivering impactful solutions like a model for predicting insurance claim denials. In subsequent roles, I expanded my expertise in NLP by developing a chatbot using the RASA framework and managed end-to-end project lifecycles, leading initiatives such as an On-Demand Delivery Assortment Dashboard and a Market Media Mix Model. Currently, as a Data Scientist at Tiger Analytics, I lead projects from inception to deployment, including a Trade Promotion & Optimization project for the Poland pet market, leveraging Python's Pulp library and Bayesian Regression to enhance accuracy. My focus on predictive modeling and strategic analytics has consistently driven business value and client satisfaction.

Due to confidentiality agreements with my organizations, I am unable to showcase specific projects publicly. However, to demonstrate my technical skills and work, I have created a [GitHub portfolio](#), where I have uploaded relevant projects and code samples. Please feel free to explore it.

Beyond my professional life, volunteering has been a deeply transformative experience. Initially hesitant, I found park cleaning to be incredibly rewarding. Through this, I engaged with diverse

groups. Through this, I engaged with diverse groups, exchanging cultures, languages, arts, history, and festivals, discovering that while we are all uniquely different, we share common threads that unite us, all while expanding my community connections. This experience underscored the power of teamwork, and the importance of giving back, and inspired eco-friendly practices. Volunteering became a therapeutic outlet for me, nurturing both my personal and professional growth, and bringing me closer to nature.

I am eager to pursue the (Program Name) at the (University Name), as its comprehensive curriculum and diverse electives align perfectly with my career aspirations (eg: Specific Modules, labs, research etc.). The opportunity to collaborate with a globally diverse student community will enrich my learning, broaden my perspectives, and foster intellectual growth. Guided by world-class faculty in a collaborative environment, this program will deepen my expertise and open new opportunities in the field of data science.

Upon completing this program, I aim to leverage the skills and knowledge gained to contribute effectively within my organization. My immediate goal is to work as a Data Scientist, Business Analyst, or Data Analyst in leading product-based companies like Samsung R&D, Amazon, Apple, Microsoft, Walmart, or Google. I aim to apply strategic and sustainable solutions to solve complex business problems, enhancing efficiency and decision-making. In the long term, I aspire to contribute to or establish a Data Science community that fosters individual growth and promotes collective success. I envision creating an environment where collaboration and shared learning enable everyone to thrive, pushing the boundaries of innovation and continuously driving progress within the field of Data Science.

Though I am currently employed and earning, I have been supporting my family financially, which has placed a significant strain on my resources. Additionally, the currency difference between INR and the pound, along with the added burden of living expenses, has made it challenging for me to afford further studies. Despite my desire to advance academically and professionally, the current economic conditions limit my ability to pursue this opportunity without external support. A scholarship and tuition fee waiver would be a vital catalyst, allowing me to focus on my education and achieve my long-term goals.

Given my strong educational background, diverse work experience across multiple domains, and active participation in extracurricular activities, I am confident that I possess the skills and potential to excel in further studies. However, due to the financial challenges, I kindly request your esteemed university to consider my candidature for the scholarship. I would be deeply grateful for the opportunity.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,
Varsha Rajawat